

DIFFERENCE

1. Passage anchor

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a nudge in the right direction, and that made all the ****difference****.”

Passage meaning

****make all the difference**** = have a decisive or very important effect on the final result

****產生關鍵作用；造成很大差別；帶來決定性的改變****

Here, ****difference**** does not simply mean “two things are not the same.” It means the teacher’s influence had a major effect on how the speaker developed.

Practice

1. One encouraging comment can ****make all the difference****.
一句鼓勵的話就可能****帶來關鍵性的影響****。
2. Having someone believe in you can ****make a huge difference****.
有人相信你，可以****帶來很大的改變****。

Core meanings of DIFFERENCE

2. difference — the way in which two or more things are not the same

= a point or feature that makes one thing unlike another

****差異；不同之處****

Examples

1. There is a big ****difference**** between the two designs.
這兩個設計之間有很大的****差異****。
2. Can you explain the ****difference**** between these words?
你可以解釋這些單字之間的****不同之處****嗎？

This is the central noun meaning.

3. difference between A and B

= the way A and B are unlike each other

****A 與 B 之間的差異****

Examples

1. What is the ****difference between**** *hear* and *listen*?
hear 和 *listen* 之間有什麼****差別****？
2. There is little ****difference between**** the two methods.
這兩種方法之間幾乎沒有什麼****差異****。

Very high-value pattern.

4. a difference in something

= a variation in a particular quality, amount, or feature

****.....方面的差異****

Examples

1. There is a clear ****difference in quality****.
品質上有明顯的****差異****。
2. We noticed a ****difference in tone****.
我們注意到語氣上有****不同****。

Degree of difference

5. big / major / significant difference

= a large or important difference

****很大的 / 重大的 / 顯著的差異****

Examples

1. There is a ****significant difference**** between the results.
這些結果之間存在****顯著差異****。
2. The new version shows a ****major difference**** in performance.
新版本在效能上顯示出****重大差異****。

6. slight / small difference

= a minor difference

細微差異；小差別

Examples

1. There is only a **slight difference** in colour.
顏色只有**些微差異**。
2. The two versions have a few **small differences**.
這兩個版本只有幾個**小差別**。

7. no difference

= no meaningful distinction between two things

沒有差別；沒有不同

Examples

1. There is **no difference** in price.
價格上**沒有差別**。
2. It makes **no difference** which route we take.
我們走哪條路都**沒有差別**。

The second example introduces another important sense: effect on outcome.

Effect / impact

8. make a difference

= have an effect on a situation or result

產生影響；造成差別

Examples

1. Small changes can **make a difference**.
小小的改變也能**產生影響**。
2. Your support really **made a difference**.
你的支持真的**帶來了改變**。

This is one of the most important figurative uses.

9. make a big / huge / real difference

= have a strong or noticeable effect

****產生很大 / 實際的影響****

Examples

1. Better communication can ****make a huge difference****.
更好的溝通可以****帶來巨大差別****。
2. Her feedback ****made a real difference**** to my confidence.
她的回饋真的****提升了我的自信，產生了實際影響****。

10. make all the difference

= be the key factor that changes the result substantially

****產生決定性影響；成為關鍵****

This is the exact passage expression.

Examples

1. A little preparation can ****make all the difference****.
一點準備就可能****成為關鍵****。
2. Her encouragement ****made all the difference**** when I was struggling.
我在低潮時，她的鼓勵****起了決定性的作用****。

11. make no difference

= have no effect on the outcome

****沒有影響；沒有差別****

Examples

1. It ****makes no difference**** what time we leave.
我們什麼時候離開都****沒有影響****。

2. His apology **made no difference** to her decision.

他的道歉對她的決定**沒有造成任何影響**。

12. make little difference

= have only a small effect

影響很小

Examples

1. The change **made little difference** to the final result.

這項改變對最終結果**影響不大**。

2. Extra practice made only a **small difference**.

額外練習只帶來了**些微影響**。

Distinction / discrimination

13. tell the difference

= recognize how two things are different

分辨差異；看出不同

Examples

1. I can't **tell the difference** between the two versions.

我分不出這兩個版本的**差別**。

2. Can you **tell the difference** between real and fake leather?

你能分辨真皮和假皮的**不同**嗎？

Very common.

14. see / notice a difference

= perceive that something has changed or differs

看出 / 注意到差異

Examples

1. Can you **see the difference**?

你看得出**差別**嗎？

2. I noticed a **difference** after a few weeks.

幾週後，我注意到了**變化**。

Change over time

15. difference — change compared with an earlier state

= a noticeable change from how something was before

變化；改變

Examples

1. I can see a real **difference** in her confidence.

我可以看出她的自信真的有**變化**。

2. The treatment made a noticeable **difference**.

治療帶來了明顯的**改善 / 變化**。

This is closely related to impact.

Disagreement

16. difference — disagreement of opinion

= a disagreement between people

分歧；意見不同

Examples

1. They had a **difference of opinion**.

他們有**意見分歧**。

2. We have our **differences**, but we still work well together.

我們雖然有**分歧**，但仍然合作得很好。

This is a distinct social meaning.

17. differences

= disagreements or points of conflict between people or groups

****分歧；矛盾****

Examples

1. The two sides are trying to resolve their ****differences****.

雙方正試圖解決彼此的****分歧****。

2. They put aside their ****differences****.

他們暫時放下彼此的****歧見****。

18. difference of opinion

= disagreement about what is true, best, or preferable

****意見分歧****

Examples

1. We had a ****difference of opinion**** about the strategy.

我們對策略有****意見分歧****。

2. A ****difference of opinion**** does not have to become a conflict.

****意見不同****不一定要變成衝突。

Numerical difference

19. difference — amount by which two numbers or quantities differ

= the result of comparing or subtracting one quantity from another

****差額；差值****

Examples

1. The ****difference**** between 10 and 6 is 4.

10 和 6 的****差****是 4。

2. There is a \$20 ****difference**** in price.

價格有 20 美元的****差額****。

20. price difference

= amount by which two prices differ

價差；價格差異

Examples

1. The **price difference** is quite small.

價差很小。

2. Is the quality worth the **difference in price**?

品質值得那個**價格差異**嗎？

Social / cultural variation

21. cultural differences

= ways in which cultures differ in values, behavior, customs, etc.

文化差異

Examples

1. **Cultural differences** can affect communication.

文化差異可能影響溝通。

2. Travelling made her more aware of **cultural differences**.

旅行讓她更了解**文化上的差異**。

22. individual differences

= ways in which people differ from one another

個別差異；個體差異

Examples

1. Teachers need to consider **individual differences**.

老師需要考慮學生的**個別差異**。

2. Learning speed varies because of **individual differences**.

學習速度會因**個體差異**而有所不同。

Related forms

23. different

= not the same

****不同的****

Examples

1. We have ****different opinions****.
我們有****不同的意見****。
2. Her approach is completely ****different from mine****.
她的方法和我的****完全不同****。

24. different from

= not the same as

****與.....不同****

Examples

1. This version is ****different from the original****.
這個版本和原版****不同****。
2. Her experience was very ****different from mine****.
她的經歷和我的****很不一樣****。

For learners, ****different from**** is the safest general pattern.

25. differently

= in a different way

****不同地；以不同方式****

Examples

1. People learn ****differently****.
每個人的學習方式都****不同****。

2. I see the issue ****differently**** now.

我現在對這個問題有****不同的看法****。

26. differ

= be different

****不同；有差異****

Examples

1. The two methods ****differ**** in several ways.

這兩種方法在幾個方面****有所不同****。

2. Opinions ****differ**** on the issue.

大家對這個問題的看法****不一****。

27. differ from

= be unlike another thing

****與.....不同****

Examples

1. Her approach ****differs from mine****.

她的方法****和我的不同****。

2. The two models ****differ from each other**** in size.

這兩個型號的大小****彼此不同****。

28. differ on / over something

= disagree about something

****對.....有不同意見；在.....上有分歧****

Examples

1. Experts ****differ on**** the best solution.

專家對最佳解決方案****意見不一****。

2. The two groups **differed over** the strategy.

兩個團體在策略上**出現分歧**。

Fixed expressions

29. a world of difference

= a very large difference

天壤之別；極大的差異

Examples

1. Good lighting can make **a world of difference**.

良好的照明可以帶來**極大的差別**。

2. A supportive teacher can make **a world of difference** to a shy student.

一位支持學生的老師對害羞的學生來說可能造成**天壤之別**。

30. split the difference

= agree on a point halfway between two amounts or positions

取中間值；折衷

Examples

1. You want 60 and I want 40, so let's **split the difference** at 50.

你要 60，我要 40，那我們就**折衷取 50**。

2. They agreed to **split the difference**.

他們同意**各退一步取中間值**。

31. bury / settle your differences

= resolve disagreements

解決分歧；化解矛盾

Examples

1. The two sides finally **settled their differences**.

雙方終於**解決了分歧**。

2. They agreed to **put their differences aside**.

他們同意暫時**放下彼此的歧見**。

Key contrasts

32. difference vs distinction

difference

= any way in which things are not the same

差異

distinction

= clear, meaningful, or deliberately recognized difference

區別 ; 差別

Compare:

> There is a small **difference** in colour.

> 顏色有一點差異。

> We need to make a clear **distinction** between fact and opinion.

> 我們需要清楚**區分**事實與意見。

33. difference vs change

difference

= comparison showing that two states/things are not the same

差異

change

= process of becoming different

改變

Compare:

> I noticed a **change** in her attitude.

> 我注意到她的態度有變化。

> There is a big **difference** between her attitude now and before.

> 她現在和以前的態度有很大差異。

34. difference vs variation

****variation****

= difference occurring within a set, pattern, or range

****變化；差異****

****difference****

is broader and more general.

Compare:

* individual differences

* variation in temperature

35. difference vs disagreement

****difference****

can politely mean a disagreement.

****disagreement****

directly means lack of agreement

****意見不合****

Compare:

> We have a few ****differences****.

> 我們有一些分歧。

This can sound softer than:

> We have several ****disagreements****.

> 我們有好幾項意見衝突。

36. make a difference vs change something

****change something****

= make it different

****make a difference****

= have a meaningful effect on the outcome or situation

Compare:

> We **changed the schedule**.

> 我們更改了時間表。

> The new schedule **made a big difference**.

> 新時間表帶來了很大的影響。

Meaning map

The central concept of **difference** is:

lack of sameness

From this develop several branches:

Comparison

difference between A and B

→ **差異**

Degree

big / slight difference

→ **大 / 小差別**

Effect

make a difference

→ **產生影響**

Decisive effect

make all the difference

→ **產生關鍵作用**

Perception

tell the difference

→ **分辨不同**

Disagreement

have differences

→ **意見分歧**

Quantity

difference in price / numerical difference

→ **差額；差值**

The passage use is especially interesting because the meaning shifts from:

things are different

→ **something causes the outcome to become meaningfully different**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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difference between A and B	A 與 B 在特徵、性質、外觀、程度等方面不相同之處；差異
difference in + feature	某個特定方面所呈現出的不同 / 差異
big/significant difference	程度明顯、重要或很大的差異
slight/small difference	程度很小、細微的不同
no difference — comparison	兩個事物在相關方面沒有有意義的不同
make a difference	對情況、結果或某人的狀態產生實際影響
make a big/huge difference	造成很大、明顯或重要的影響
make all the difference	成為改變最終結果的關鍵因素；產生決定性作用
make no difference — effect	對最終結果或情況不產生影響
tell the difference	能辨認兩者之間的不同
see/notice a difference	察覺某人 / 某物相較之前或其他事物已有不同
difference — change in condition	相較之前所出現的明顯變化
difference — disagreement	人與人之間在意見、立場或看法上的分歧
differences between people/groups	雙方存在的意見分歧、矛盾或不同立場
difference of opinion	對同一問題持有不同看法；意見分歧
numerical difference	兩個數值相差的數量；差值
price difference	兩個價格之間的差額 / 價差
cultural differences	不同文化在價值、習慣、行為等方面的差異
individual differences	不同個人在能力、特質、需求等方面的差異
different	不相同的；不同的
differ	在某方面不相同；有差異
differ on/over	對某議題持不同意見；有分歧
a world of difference	非常巨大、明顯的差異；天壤之別
split the difference	在兩個數值或立場之間取中間值作為折衷

Passage recap

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a nudge in the right direction, and that **made all the difference**.”

Here:

difference = **a major change in the outcome caused by an important influence**

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **帶來了關鍵性的改變** *

* **產生了決定性的影響** *

* **結果因此完全不同** *

* naturally: **而那一點點推動，最後卻帶來了很大的改變** *

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

make all the difference

= **have a decisive or extremely important effect on the result**

產生決定性影響；成為關鍵；帶來關鍵性的改變

It does not simply mean **「造成所有差異」** literally.

The expression means:

without that factor, the outcome might have been very different.